Steamer



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Steamer

What it is used for

A steamer uses hot steam to cook food, soften materials, or carry out an approved heating process. Correct loading and temperature control help achieve consistent results and reduce burn risks.

Main parts

- Steaming chamber or cooking vessel
- Lid or chamber door
- Steam generator or steam inlet
- Water reservoir and level indicator if fitted
- Temperature and timer controls
- Trays, racks, and condensate drain

Before you start

1. Read the equipment instructions and confirm the intended use and capacity.
2. Inspect the chamber, lid, seals, controls, power cable, and steam connections.
3. Check the water level and use the specified water quality.
4. Ensure drains and steam outlets are clear and the equipment stands securely.
5. Arrange food or materials on trays without blocking steam circulation.
6. Wear suitable protection and keep the work area dry.

How to use

1. Add water or connect the approved steam supply as specified by the manufacturer.
2. Switch on the steamer and allow it to reach the required operating condition.
3. Load trays carefully and leave sufficient space for steam circulation.
4. Close the lid or door securely using the designed locking method.
5. Set the required temperature and time for the product or process.
6. Monitor the cycle and avoid opening the chamber unnecessarily.
7. When the cycle ends, switch off steam generation and wait for pressure to release where applicable.
8. Open the lid or door slowly, directing escaping steam away from the body.
9. Remove trays using suitable heat-resistant protection and place them on a stable surface.
10. Switch off, cool, drain if required, and clean the chamber after use.

⚠ Safety

- Hot steam can cause severe burns; keep face and hands away from escaping steam.
- Never force open a pressurized chamber or bypass its interlocks.
- Do not operate the steamer without the required water level or steam supply.
- Use heat-resistant gloves and suitable tools when removing hot trays.
- Keep electrical connections dry and disconnect power before cleaning electrical parts.
- Report damaged seals, blocked drains, and abnormal pressure or temperature readings.

Care & storage

- Clean the chamber, trays, lid, and seals after the equipment cools.
- Remove scale according to the manufacturer's descaling instructions and approved chemicals.
- Inspect seals, hoses, drains, and safety controls regularly.
- Drain and store the unit as instructed when it will remain unused.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Opening the lid too quickly can expose the operator to hot steam.
- Overloading trays can prevent uniform steaming.
- Operating with insufficient water can damage heating components.
- Using unsuitable descaling chemicals can damage internal surfaces and seals.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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